



Wilder — A seeming characterized by a desire to explore and push boundaries.

Inspirational Material

The following is a list of material that is universally **Changeling**-related. Beyond this, though, anything from a well-worn collection of fairy tales to *Cosmos* (either version) to a book about geology can be inspirational for this game, if it's something that sparks awe and wonder in you. If it's something that reminds you of what it was like to be young. Yes, even *that*. If it's inspirational material for you, that's really all that matters.

For material that particularly suits the themes and setting of **Changeling**, literature that might help includes the entire body of work of Neil Gaiman, especially *Stardust* and *Neverwhere*, the latter of which features a hidden London where urban legends and fairy tales are real, and an average man's attempt to make sense of the world that has drawn him in. *Faerie Tale* by Raymond Feist, *Jonathan Strange and Mr Norrell* by Susanna Clarke, and *The Phantom Tollbooth* by Norton Juster involve faerie strangeness invading on a plain, banal life. For games involving the Kinain, or that skew further into urban fantasy, the *October Daye* series by Seanan McGuire is indispensable.

If you'd prefer movies, *The Dark Crystal* (dir. Jim Henson & Frank Oz, 1982), *Labyrinth* (dir. Jim Henson, 1986), *The Neverending Story* (dir. Wolfgang Peterson, 1984), *The Secret of Roan Inish* (dir. John Sayles, 1994), and *Pan's Labyrinth* (dir. Guillermo del Toro, 2006) feature children of varying involvement in the world we know setting out on fantasy adventures. Anything directed by Hayao Miyazaki fits, in particular *Princess Mononoke* (1997), which is about a clash between spirits trying to hold on to the last bits of magic in a rapidly-modernizing world.

Television shows that examine the concept of fairy tales existing alongside humans are particularly common, the highlights of which are *Grimm*, *Once Upon a Time*, and *Lost Girl*. For a less literal take on *Changeling*'s themes, the Japanese show *Hikonin Sentai Akibaranger* is about social outcasts turning their dreams and obsessions into power. The Akibarangers fight enemies to defend Akihabara, Tokyo's electronics district and a fandom mecca, from forces that would replace it with something more plain and "acceptable."

Finally, video games that grapple with the contrast of fantasy clashing with "reality" include *Final Fantasy Tactics Advance* and *The Longest Journey*. While they don't necessarily fit the theme of **Changeling**, games like *Ico*, *Shadow of the Colossus*, and *NiGHTS Into Dreams* are excellent inspiration for the visuals and feel of the stranger parts of the Dreaming.